

CLIENT GROWTH STRATEGY MEETING

The Outreach Call Playbook

Marketing Sweet · Sales debrief · May 2026

THE BIG IDEA

Stop saving clients. Start selling them. Two upsells offset one cancellation — but only if you hold the line, read the room, and replace discounts with backlinks.

#1 READ THE ROOM

Diagnose green vs red accounts before you open your mouth.

#2 ANCHOR-DROP

\$1,400 → \$850 → \$550.
Marination is the technique.

#3 TROJAN HORSE

Replace every discount with backlinks.
Three-month delayed value.

#4 HOLD THE LINE

Win the corner, win the race. Pull the brake the latest.

Forget retention. I'll get that anyway.
— the mindset

Read the room

Before you open your mouth.

Same script, two different accounts. Open from strength on green; open from concern on red. Mix them up and you lose both.

GREEN ACCOUNT

performing well

Open from STRENGTH

"I'm actually quite pleased with the results we're getting. Eight on page one. But what we could be doing is getting a lot more for you."

WHY IT WORKS

- Acknowledges the work — client agrees.
- Pivots to the upside — "more for you".
- Client has nothing to push back on.
- Sets up the upsell in one breath.

RED ACCOUNT

drifting / at risk

Open from CONCERN

"I want to talk about the campaign. There's a real opportunity here — and an even bigger risk if we don't move. Let's walk through it together."

WHY IT WORKS

- Names the problem before the client does.
- Reframes risk as opportunity.
- Takes a position — the ambush advantage.
- Earns the right to recommend a fix.

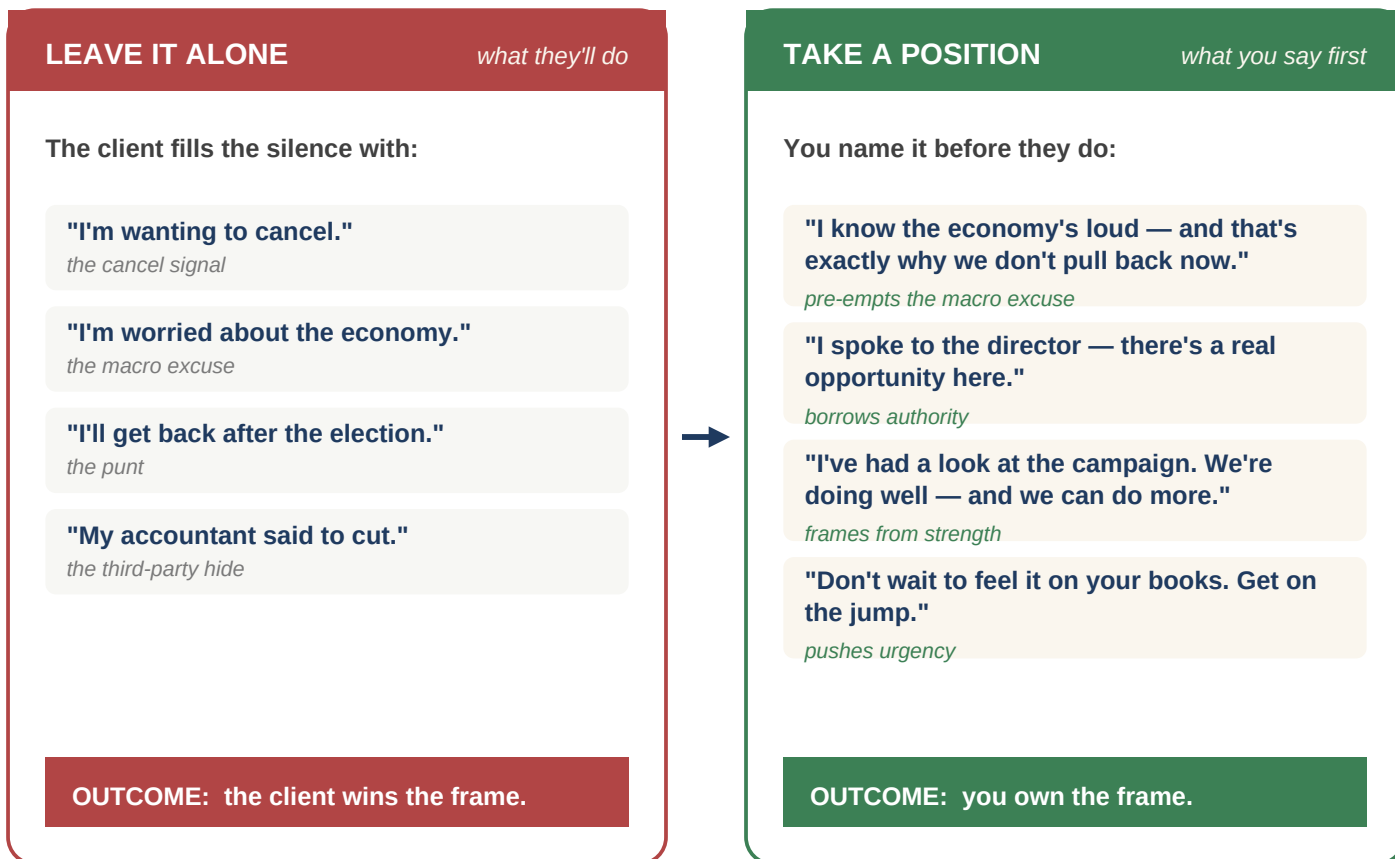
THE TRAP

Opening a GREEN account from concern ("I'm not really happy with how things are going") hands the client your worry. They run with it. "Yeah, nothing's really happened." Now you're backpedalling. Diagnose first. Script second.

The ambush advantage

Take a position first. Tell them what's in their head.

When you call up a client and they don't know you're calling, you have the whole frame to yourself. The only information they react to is what you feed them. Take a position first.



"I take a position first. I tell them what's in their head. Because if you leave it alone, they'll get caught up in their own story and the call is gone."

The ABC of clients

Every client sorts themselves into one of three types.

Most of your clients are B's — drifting. Unless you lean into them hard, the drift turns into a C. Your job on every call is to push them up the ladder, not down it.



AGGRESSOR

Leans in

WHAT THEY DO

Doubles down. Spends into the downturn. Takes market share while competitors retreat.

WHAT YOU DO

Reinforce. Show them growth opportunities. Upsell.



WATCHER

Drifts

WHAT THEY DO

Waits to see what happens. Status quo until a real event forces a decision. Eventually slides down.

WHAT YOU DO

Lean in hard. Push them up to A — or they slide to C.



RETRACTED

Pulls out

WHAT THEY DO

Already decided to cut. Cancelling subscriptions, killing marketing, hiding from the call.

WHAT YOU DO

Hold the line. Don't discount. Trojan-horse them or let them go.

WHERE YOUR BOOK SITS, ROUGHLY

A · 15%

B · 65% (the drift — your real job)

C · 20%

Offensive vs defensive

Why two upsells beat ten saves.

There's a mindset split: try to save clients with discounts (defensive) or try to upsell into the relationship (offensive). The maths is brutal on the defensive side.

THE MATHS

Average account: \$200/mo. Upsell to \$850/mo = +\$650 (a ~325% account-value lift on that client). Two of those = ~\$1,300/mo in new MRR — enough to absorb six full \$200 cancellations.

The defensive play: discount 10% on a \$200 account = save \$20/mo. Lose the client six months later anyway. Net: -\$220 and a damaged price point.

DEFENSIVE · SAVE

- ✗ **Lead with discount**
Trains the client to ask again next quarter.
- ✗ **Try to keep every client**
The weak ones drag down the average.
- ✗ **Reduces dollar value per account**
Permanent erosion.
- ✗ **Loses the client anyway, 6 months later**
Double-dipped in the worst way.
- ✗ **Mindset: retention**
Retention follows growth — not the other way round.

OFFENSIVE · SELL

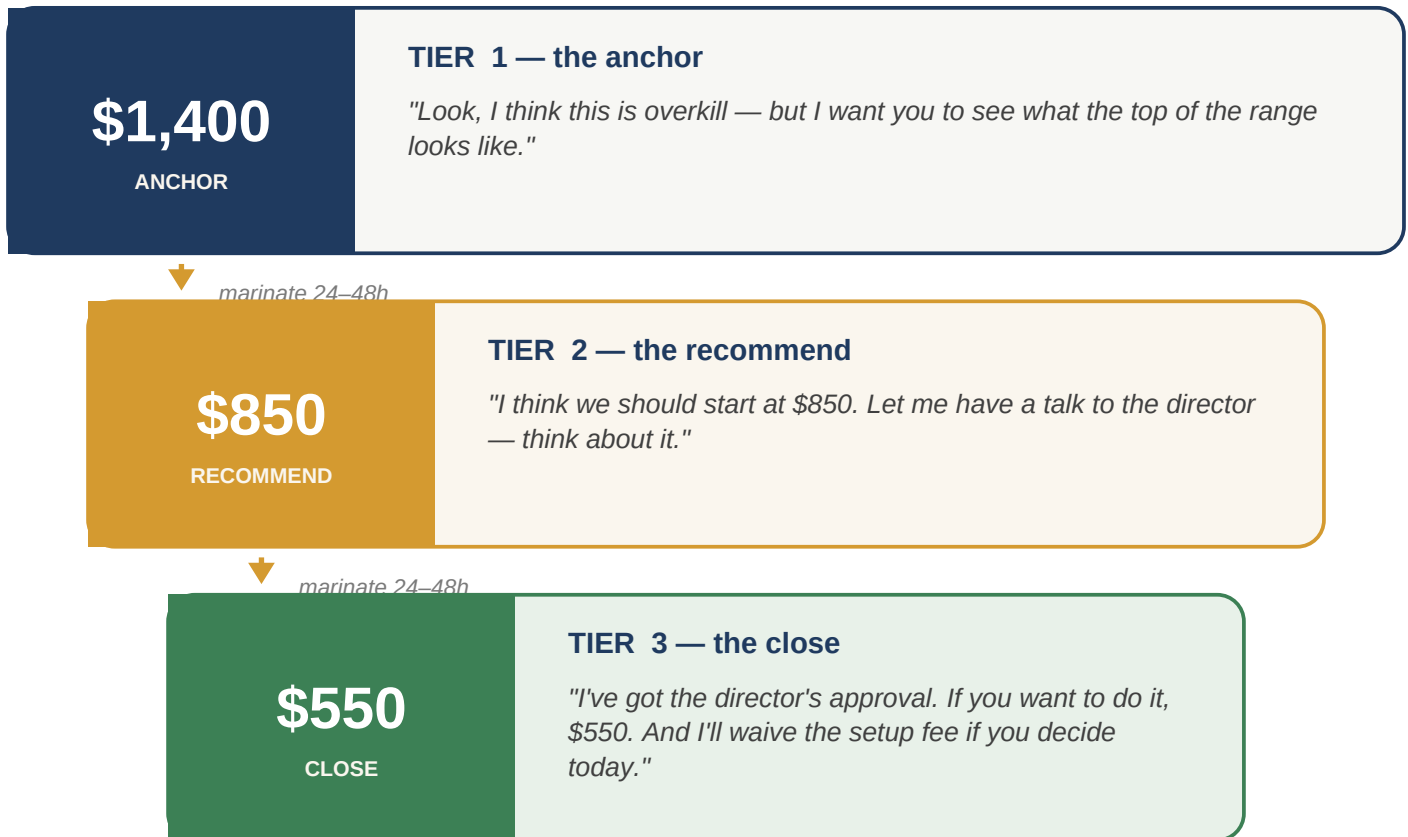
- ✓ **Lead with value add**
Backlinks, web hours, a Trojan horse.
- ✓ **Let weak accounts fall on their own sword**
They were never the clients you wanted.
- ✓ **Increases dollar value per account**
Compounds across the book.
- ✓ **Loses the client and replaces them with two upsells**
Net positive on revenue and on price discipline.
- ✓ **Mindset: growth**
Retention takes care of itself.

"Forget retention — I'll get that anyway. I'm relentlessly hungry. That's the mindset."

The anchor-drop pricing dance

\$1,400 → \$850 → \$550. Marination is the technique.

Never lead with the number you want. Anchor high, walk down to the middle, let them marinate, then come back with the low tier framed as a personal favour. You're not discounting — you're creating the space for the price you wanted all along.



WHY IT WORKS

- › The \$1,400 anchor makes \$850 sound reasonable.
- › The \$850 marination makes \$550 feel like a win — not a discount.
- › "Director's approval" raises the perceived value of the concession.
- › A bird in the hand: if they were on the edge, the drop tips them over.

Trojan-horse the save

Replace discounts with backlinks. Lock it in three days later.

When a client wants to cancel, the instinct is to discount. Don't. Replace it with a value-add that costs you almost nothing — and that gives you a fresh reason to call back in three months.

THE TROJAN HORSE

THE SCRIPT

"I've literally found a way to not reduce your price — but I've authorized something I'm not supposed to. Don't tell anyone. I've added five backlinks to your account. They'll take effect over the next three months."

WHY BACKLINKS BEAT A DISCOUNT

- › **They cost you almost nothing.**
Margin protected.
- › **They take three months to land.**
Fresh reason to call back.
- › **They reassure the client the save was real.**
No buyer's remorse.
- › **"Authorized something I'm not supposed to."**
Lifts perceived value without discounting.

THE 3-DAY FOLLOW-UP

DAY 0

Save call.

Client wants to cancel. You hold the line. They agree to stay.

DAY 3

Reassurance call.

"Just calling to let you know everything's running smoothly. I've added 3 hours of web work to your account."

MONTH 3

Results call.

"Remember those backlinks? Look at your rankings. Now — about referrals..."

A discount ends the conversation. A backlink package opens the next one. Three months from now, you walk back in with results and ask for the upsell.

Daily reference card

Stick this on the wall. Read it before every outreach block.

Win the corner. Win the race. Anyone can hold the throttle flat. Where you actually win is in the corner — and the corner is the moment the client pushes back.

DO · THE NEW REP

- ✓ **Diagnose first.**
Green or red? Pitch the right way.
- ✓ **Take a position.**
Tell them what's in their head.
- ✓ **Open from strength on green.**
"Pleased with results — and we could be getting more."
- ✓ **Anchor high.**
\$1,400 first. Walk down to \$850. Marinate.
- ✓ **Hold the line on price.**
"Don't chop your marketing — that's the line item bringing the revenue in."
- ✓ **Trojan-horse the save.**
Backlinks or web hours — never a discount.
- ✓ **Book the 3-day follow-up.**
Diary it before you hang up.
- ✓ **Sell into the economy frame.**
Be the change. Lean in. Take the corner.

DON'T · THE OLD REP

- ✗ **Don't read the script blind.**
Adapt to the account in front of you.
- ✗ **Don't open green accounts from concern.**
You hand the client your worry. They run with it.
- ✗ **Don't lead with the price you want.**
Anchor high or you'll bleed margin.
- ✗ **Don't close on the first call.**
Let them marinate. Vacuum the price down second time around.
- ✗ **Don't discount to save.**
You damage the price point and lose them anyway.
- ✗ **Don't fold in the corner.**
Hold the line — "there's nowhere to move on price."
- ✗ **Don't leave the silence open.**
They'll fill it with the cancellation.
- ✗ **Don't sound like a salesperson.**
Sound like a business person — talk economy, cycles, positioning.

Stop saving. Start selling. Be the aggressor. Two upsells cover one cancellation. Three reasons to ring back beat one discount.